

Spider

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Many spiders produce silk and make sticky webs to trap prey. The yellow-and-black garden spider spins a web like a bicycle wheel to catch flying insects, including flies, grasshoppers, and wasps. The females are the main web builders, weaving a new web each day.

Good vibrations

When a male spider arrives to court the female, he plucks the silk strands of her web to make it vibrate. If she likes the pattern of the vibrations, she mates with him. The male dies during mating, and the female sometimes eats his body afterward.

The male sometimes waves his legs around and dances to impress the female.

Silk threads radiate out from the center like the spokes of a bicycle wheel.

Making a web

The female spider builds the frame of her web by attaching silk threads to surfaces such as plant stems. Then she lays a spiral of dry silk to hold the threads in place and finally adds a spiral of sticky silk.

Spiders use silk produced by organs called spinnerets at the end of their abdomens.

A spiral of sticky silk traps insects that land on the web.

The spider stays in the middle, waiting for insects to be caught.

Zigzag bands may help birds see the web so that they don't blunder into it.

Gift wrapped The male nursery-web spider gives a present of food, wrapped in silk, to the female he hopes to mate with. A male that turns up empty-handed is more likely to be eaten by the female.



Daddy longlegs The female daddy longlegs spider bundles up her eggs with a few strands of silk. She carries the eggs around in her jaws until they hatch. During this time, she is unable to eat.

